

HOSTILE

SITUATION REPORT #005

One Of Us

ZOZER

An NPC or Adventure Seed
for HOSTILE

ONE OF US [Scenario]

A scenario seed for three players and a referee in the **HOSTILE** sci-fi setting:

www.paulelliottbooks.com/hostile.html

ASSUMPTIONS

This scenario is a one-shot with pregenerated characters for a single game only. One or all of the characters may die during this scenario – it is deadly. The referee can create three spacer characters (civilian or military) for the players to choose from; they may even be civilians en route to a colony or on their way to Earth.

PLAYER'S BRIEFING

The three player-characters wake up, blurry, sick and with a dreadful hang-over. Each is in basic starship underwear and inside a hypersleep chamber that is opening and slowly deactivating - cryogenic gasses seep with a hiss from vents nearby. Everyone is disorientated and the red strobe lights in the tiny cabin don't help. Where are they? After groping through the mist and the flashing lights, they realise they are in a small single-cabin shuttle. All have amnesia, no-one can remember who they are or why they are there, or crucially, what happened to get them into a hypersleep chamber.

DISCOVERY & DILEMMA

After getting dressed, shutting off alarms, vents and sirens, the characters see they are in an Orchid class Lifeboat, a small 10-ton lifeboat designed to take up to three hypersleep passengers (and five awake passengers, or which there are none). There is a rear hatch, to the port of it is a fresher, to the starboard are the three hypersleep pods. The middle of the shuttle is a cargo deck. Forward is a cluster of five passenger seats, and in front of them are two pilot seats – there are no pilots, this lifeboat is in orbit and seems to be manoeuvring to make a descent to the world's surface. More details are in Zozer Games' *Gunboats & Shuttles* book. By the way, on the cargo deck, in plain view of each character, is the dried, upturned husk of a Reticulan Impregnator (page 214 of the revised **HOSTILE Setting** book). This resembles a fiendish, pale spider with a snake-like tail. It is dead. The characters have heard rumours of this creature and what it does. One of the characters has most likely been impregnated with an alien egg which will develop and the creature erupt violently through the victim's chest, quickly devouring any person in the area. But who is it? You know it isn't you. What do the players do?

CRASH LANDING

Meanwhile the lifeboat enters the atmosphere and lands in a scrub-desert terrain. There are ten DeWitt survival bags on board. If they can work out which world they are on using the ship's data and where they are, they can plan a three-day trek through the wilderness to reach a small colony settlement. There may be dust storms, predators and privation – but that's just the side-dish. How do the players react to one another? Give one character a bad stomach ache – can he hide it? Another might be sick from bad water or rations – is this the xenomorph arriving? Or just a 'dicky tummy'. When they meet a father and son hunting, armed with rifles ... are they tempted to seize the guns to use for their own defence? What if the colonists find out? Of course the finale will be when the alien finally does burst through one of their chests. Have you warned the player first!??

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